Write it like you mean it!

A FOR AND AGAINST ESSAY

What's a for and against essay?

A for and against essay presents both sides of an argument before giving a balanced conclusion. To write a good for and against essay:

- **Paragraph 1 (introduction):** Introduce the topic and say that there are two sides.
- **Paragraph 2 (points for):** Present arguments in favor of the topic.
- **Paragraph 3 (points against):** Present arguments against the topic.
- **Paragraph 4 (conclusion):** Summarize both sides and give your balanced opinion.

Choose a prompt to start practising

- Is artificial intelligence a danger to humanity or a helpful tool?
- Should animals be used for experiments and scientific research?
- Is money really the key to happiness?
- Should people stop eating meat to save the planet?
- Is it better to live in a big city or in the countryside?

Try to include

- **Linkers (For):** *Firstly*, *in addition*, *moreover*, *one advantage is that...*
- **Linkers (Against):** *However*, *on the other hand*, *despite this*, *one disadvantage is that...*
- **Opinion phrases**: *In my opinion*, *I believe that...*, *Personally*, *I think...*, *It seems to me that...*
- **Conclusion phrases:** *To sum up*, *On balance*, *All things considered...*

Pro tip and challenge!

- **PRO TIP:** Keep a formal style: no contractions, no slang. Also, don't start by saying *I think...* Introduce the topic in general terms explaining why it's relevant, as in *Nowadays, more and more people are talking about AI*; *There has been a lot of debate about whether AI is helping us or making us dumber*.
- **CHALLENGE:** Try to include at least three points for and three points against.

Time to start working!

1. Use the cloud to brainstorm all the ideas you have.
2. Once your ideas are ready, use a different piece of paper to write a rough draft.
3. Make the necessary edits. Check grammar, spelling, cohesion and coherence.
4. Write the final version.
5. Don't forget to clearly state your opinion in the conclusion.

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A DESCRIPTION

What's a description?

A description paints a picture with words. It can describe a person, place, object, or event using vivid language and sensory details. To write a good description:

- **Paragraph 1 (introduction):** Introduce what you're describing and why.
- **Paragraph 2 (details):** Describe the main features of what you're describing.
- **Paragraph 3 (details):** Add extra information, feelings or impressions.
- **Paragraph 4 (closing):** Conclude with a final thought.

Choose a prompt to start practising

- Describe a teacher who changed your life.
- Describe the most beautiful sunset you've ever seen in your life.
- Describe a gift you received that you'll never forget.
- Describe a day that went completely wrong.
- Describe what the world might look like in 100 years.

Try to include

- **Adjectives:** *beautiful*, *noisy*, *colorful*, *peaceful*, *bright*, *cozy...*
- **Sensory language:** *It looked...*, *It smelled...*, *I could hear...*, *The air felt...*
- **Linkers:** *in the distance*, *beside*, *next to*, *suddenly*, *at that moment...*
- **Expressions:** *What I loved most was...*, *I'll never forget...*, *It made me feel...*

Pro tip and challenge!

- **PRO TIP:** Use the five senses to make your description come alive (*everywhere I looked, colours burst like fireworks: bright reds, soft blues...*; *the thunder cracked above me*; *I could smell freshly baked bread*). Vary sentence length and use strong adjectives.
- **CHALLENGE:** Try to include a couple of rhetorical figures like a simile (*as bright as the sun*), or a metaphor (*the city was a jungle*).

Time to start working!

1. Use the cloud to brainstorm all the ideas you have.
2. Once your ideas are ready, use a different piece of paper to write a rough draft.
3. Make the necessary edits. Check grammar, spelling, cohesion and coherence.
4. Write the final version.
5. Don't forget to use descriptive language and sensory details.

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A FORMAL EMAIL

What's a formal email?

A formal email is written to someone you don't know well (e.g. a teacher, company, or official). It uses polite, respectful and clear language. To write a good formal email:

- **Paragraph 1 (opening):** Greeting + reason for writing.
- **Paragraph 2 (body):** Explain the situation, give details or ask questions politely.
- **Paragraph 3 (body):** Thank the reader, express expectations or say what you hope for.
- **Paragraph 4 (closing):** Friendly ending + your name.

Choose a prompt to start practising

- Write to a company to request information about a product or service.
- Write to apply for a summer course or part-time job.
- Write to your teacher asking for clarification about a project.
- Write to a hotel to make a booking or ask about their facilities.
- Write to a restaurant to express dissatisfaction with a meal or service.

Try to include

- **Polite phrases:** *I am writing to..., I would like to..., Could you please..., I would be grateful if...*
- **Linkers:** *Furthermore, in addition, regarding..., as mentioned earlier...*
- **Closing expressions:** *I look forward to hearing from you. / Thank you for your time and consideration.*

Pro tip and challenge!

- **PRO TIP:** Keep your tone polite and professional. Avoid using *I'm* or *Can you...?*. Instead say *I am* or *Could you...?* Also, use active voice to sound confident: *I am writing to request...* instead of *This email is written to request...*
- **CHALLENGE:** Try to include some of these formal phrases.

Dear Sir or Madam, *I would like to clarify that...*

Would it be possible to...? *Yours sincerely,...*

Time to start working!

1. Use the cloud to brainstorm all the ideas you have.
2. Once your ideas are ready, use a different piece of paper to write a rough draft.
3. Make the necessary edits. Check grammar, spelling, cohesion and coherence.
4. Write the final version.
5. Don't forget to check tone and politeness.

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